A SERIOUS SPORTS PAGE

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NEWS FROM A SERIOUS FOOTBALL LEAGUE

ISSUE 41

ASFL RIVALRY EXPLODES INTO REAL WORLD, HER MAJESTY IS A FRAUD

SUNNY DAY
CHUCK DOWNFIELD

One of the biggest bombshells in ASFL history is roiling the league this week. Dawn Burney, manager of A New Dawn, held a press conference on Tuesday where she made a major accusation against rival manager Melanie Shayer of Her Majesty's Royal Army. "It's time the world knew... there is no 'Her Majesty,' she was invented by Melanie to subjugate the football population of the realm." The realm formerly known as "Her Majesty's Realm" has seen increasing political upheaval in recent weeks as the team played poorly and suffered the wrath of "Her Majesty." A win in Week 5 wasn't enough to turn the tide of the growing rebellion, and after Burney's press conference yesterday, the kingdom is in open revolt. Shayer responded with a presser of her own, saying, "This is a transparent attempt to gain an advantage in next week's matchup, and Dawn should mind her own business and keep politics out of sports." Burney clipped the comment and responded on social media with another jab: "Speaking of keeping politics out of sports, I've heard that Melanie punishes and injures players that don't fit her perfect (straight, white, male) mold of what a 'knight' should be." Burney has made it clear that unusual or fantastical creatures who feel discriminated against in Her Majesty's realm are always welcome to emigrate to her own stadium, accessed through a small fairy door located in the backyard of that one old lady's overgrown garden behind the gas station.

DOMINATING UNTIL INFINITY

The Down Under Influencers are on the longest winning streak of any team in the league right now, taking down their last four in a row. "Vibes have never been higher," said manager Aaron DeSantiago after the most recent win. "I've forgotten what it feels like to lose. I may never lose again." DeSantiago kept smiling as the room got really quiet.

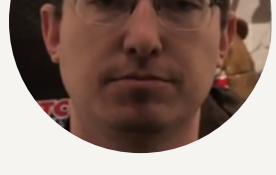


Have you ever enjoyed a day with weather so perfect it makes you forget what winter is? Asking for no reason.

Featured Matchup: Her Majesty's Royal Army @ A New Dawn

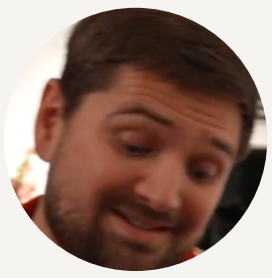
The meeting between Her Majesty's Royal Army and A New Dawn will be tense for reasons covered above the fold, but how is the so-called "Twin Bowl" affecting the rest of the league? Kris Burney and Sam Shayer are rooting for their wives. "You know what they say, 'when Her Majesty's happy, she won't slap ol' Pappy'," said Shayer. Meanwhile, Power Pwincesses manager Mallory DeSantiago said, "I hope they knock each other out to make room for the one true fantasy team."

Noteworthies



Baller of the Week: QB Drake Maye (FotF), 39.46 pts

Drake Maye has had a perfect comeback story over the last few weeks. This baby-faced quarterback was recently cut from the Buzzin' Buzzers roster, but this week he led his new team to victory. Team insiders report that a rivalry is growing between Maye and teammate Trevor Lawrence, to decide which of them gets to be Boromir and which is stuck being Faramir.

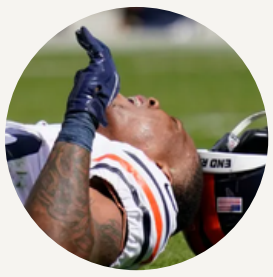


Walloping of the Week: Fellowship of the Football defeats Lawn Darts

Kris Burney's Lawn Darts have only won one game since QB Jaxson Dart went down in a surprising injury. Even neutral observers are starting to say it looks like things are fixed against the team, but the mystery remains who would stand to gain from the franchise being thwarted. For now, co-owner Lawrence Barnett Jr. grows increasingly frustrated in the owner's box.

Nailbiter of the Week: Max the Manx defeats Ashton Djenty

Matt Tribble's team Ashton Djenty couldn't quite pull off the comeback against playoff favorite Max the Manx this week. At 2-3, Tribble is beginning to wonder if the progressive, rhythmic, technically complex style of his offense is the right path after all. "Just run the damn ball," was the advice from rival manager Beth Tribble after the contest.



Injury News of the Week: RB David Montgomery (HMRA) has normal groin

Midway through this week's game, RB David Montgomery exited the field grasping his groin in a normal and not concerning way. "I'm fine. Her Majesty didn't hurt me in any way," he said after the game, blinking rapidly. Next week's opponent, A New Dawn, has made it clear that eunuchs and/or victims of castration are welcome beyond the fairy door.

Benchwarmer of the Week: WR Christian Watson (FotF), 32.3 pts

Christian Watson didn't play this week because he was studying for Map Tap league. He correctly identified 32.3 nations in Africa (partial credit for Mali/Malawi). Keep studying!

League Standings

Rank	Team	Record	Next Week
1.	Down Under Influencers	4-1	@ GPOP
2.	Max the Manx	4-1	@ BUZZ
3.	Fellowship of the Football	3-2	@ PPs
4.	A New Dawn	3-2	vs. HMRA
5.	Jasmine’s Fav	3-2	vs. HW
6.	Her Majesty’s Royal Army	2-3	@ DEB
7.	The Girly Pops	2-3	vs. DUI
8.	Lawn Darts™	2-3	@ JENT
9.	Ashton Djenty	2-3	vs. LAWN
10.	Power Pwincesses 👸	2-3	vs. FotF
11.	Buzzin’ Buzzers	2-3	vs. M
12.	Hospital Ward	1-4	@ JF